

Who to talk to first

Your network is almost entirely SLPs, which is why nobody in it can refer you. Referrals decide most documented transitions, so the first job is finding the people who already made the move. Start closer than you think.

Warm, before any stranger

- ☐ **Your grad cohort.** Search the program name on LinkedIn; five years out some are in health-tech and device companies.
- ☐ **The reps who walk into your building.** The AAC vendor, the EMR trainer, the feeding-product rep. They hold the jobs on your map and already know you.
- ☐ **The ones who already left.** The CF you supervised, the colleague who went to a vendor, your own CF supervisor.
- ☐ **What is already on your cart.** The EMR, the teletherapy platform, the assessment publisher. “I’ve used your product with clients” is an opener nobody else has.
- ☐ **People who sell you things.** Your realtor, your insurance agent, anyone from before grad school.

The warm ask, to someone you already know

I’m looking at [target title] roles, and I know you’ve been at [company] a while. Could you tell me what the [title] there actually does day to day? And if there’s someone doing it you’d trust me to talk to, I’d love fifteen minutes with them. No job ask. I’m working out whether it fits before I go further.

The first message to a stranger who made your move, under 90 words

Hi [Name], I’m an SLP in [setting] and I’m looking at [target title] roles. I found you because you made the same move. Would you be up for 15 minutes in the next couple of weeks? I’m free [two windows], or here’s a link: [booking link]. I mostly want to know how you got the first one. No job ask, I promise. If a call is too much, one question by message would still help me: [the one thing]. Either way, thank you for putting your path somewhere someone like me could find it.

Before you send it

- ☐ Names one specific thing about them
- ☐ Asks one direct question they could answer in a sentence
- ☐ A yes costs them under a minute
- ☐ No job ask, no résumé, nothing Google could answer
- ☐ You would be glad to receive it

“What do you do for work?” Then keep going

- ☐ What is the company called, and who competes with it?
- ☐ Who do you report to, and does anyone report to you?
- ☐ Does the company have customers, and who are they?
- ☐ What is your title, and has it changed since you started?
- ☐ What software is open on your screen most of the day?
- ☐ What do you hand over at the end of a week?
- ☐ Mostly with other people, or mostly alone?

Three names, tonight

WHO · HOW I KNOW
THEM

SENT

NEXT
TOUCH

Follow up once, seven to ten days later, then stop. About one in four goes unanswered; three sent is usually two conversations.